

From Claude to Tax

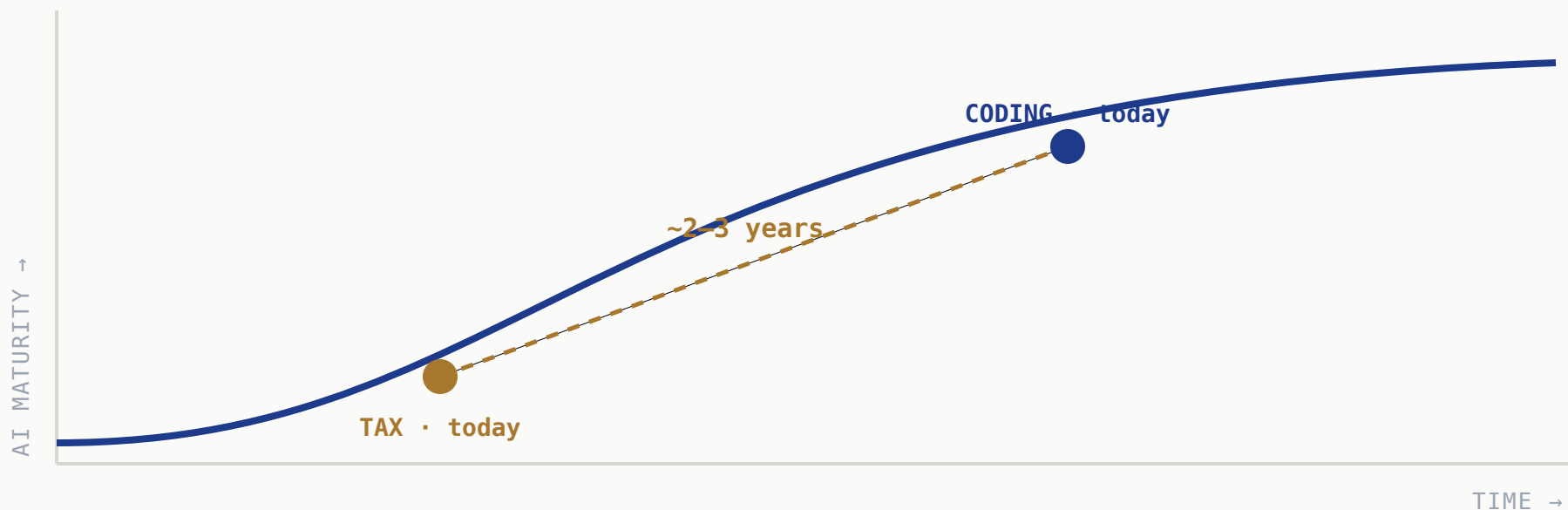
How AI evolves in three stages — what we can already see in software, and what we're building at Meta to bring it to tax.

A practical look at the infrastructure that makes it real.

START WITH WHAT WE CAN SEE

Coding is the leading indicator

Chat was AI's first act. **Coding is the next** — AI doing real work, not just talking. **Claude Code** made it the default, so coding is the map for what reaches tax next.



Same curve, a few years apart — **watch coding and you can read tax's map ahead.**

AI evolves in three stages — climbed in order

01

AI-Native Foundation

AI at **every surface** of the workflow — not a bolt-on. Humans own every step.

IN CODING

everywhere — API · Chat · IDE · code review

02

Continuous Learning

Learns from your edits & outcomes and adapts on its own. Accuracy compounds.

IN CODING

learns from accepts & fixes

03

Proactive Management

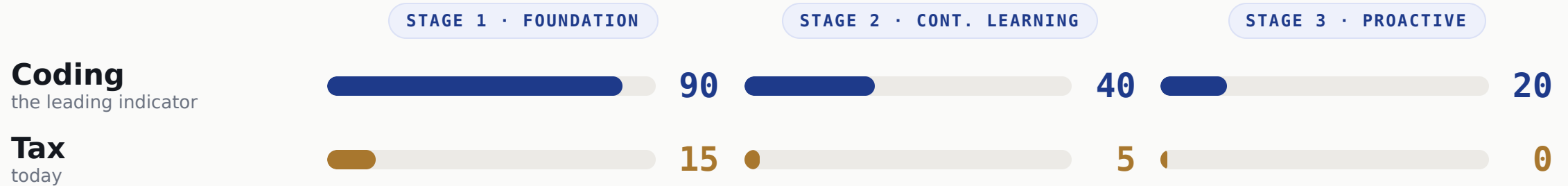
Acts *before* you ask. Near-autonomous — but a human still approves.

IN CODING

agents open a PR · you approve the merge

You can't skip a step — and the human approval gate survives all the way to the top.

Score the three stages, 0-100



Coding has finished Stage 1 and is mid-Stage 2. Tax is at the very start — **same curve, ~2-3 years apart.**

Coding figures it out first — then it diffuses

THE FRONTIER

Coding

Most investment, most talent — the playbook gets invented here first.

DIFFUSES



DOMAIN BY DOMAIN



Tax startups now starting to build here



Legal contracts, research, review



Healthcare notes, coding, claims



Finance & more each its own vertical

Each domain is its own journey. Tax is one — and the first **tax-AI startups are already appearing**. The opportunity is real; the foundation is the work.

The goal: one foundation, not fifty disconnected tools

TODAY

Every manager stitches it together by hand

Vertex

Avalara

OneSource

SAP / ERP

internal DBs

spreadsheets



FTEs carry the complex work



Big 4 absorb the repetitive work — at high cost



THE GOAL • TAX AI

One AI foundation across all of it

- Every solution, database & internal system, **connected once**
- AI takes on the **repetitive work we outsource today**
- It does the heavy lifting on the complex work too
- Experts move up to **judgment, not assembly**

Tax AI replaces the busywork and unifies the stack — so people keep the judgment.

So we start at Stage 1 — across the whole tax lifecycle

We're building **one** AI-native foundation — and every stage of the tax lifecycle draws from it.

Tax Planning

Scenario modeling & structuring, grounded in our positions and the law.

Compliance & Reporting

High-volume, rules-based work on real-time data — the natural first mover.

Tax Audit

Controversy & defense on the same lineage, sources, and document trail.

1

One AI-Native Foundation shared data · grounding · governance — under all three

Foundation first. Build it once, build it well.

From a standing start to 40+ skills in a year

Q2 '25

foundation journey began

12 mo

in, and compounding

40+

skills shipped

3

lifecycle areas live

Planning

Skills for **new product initiatives** — model the tax impact of a launch before it ships.

Compliance & Reporting

Returns & filings, automated across **10+ countries**.

Audit — an end-to-end skill

1

One-click upload

>

2

Extract audit-critical info

>

3

Auto-search every DB & internal system

>

4

Draft the audit response

>

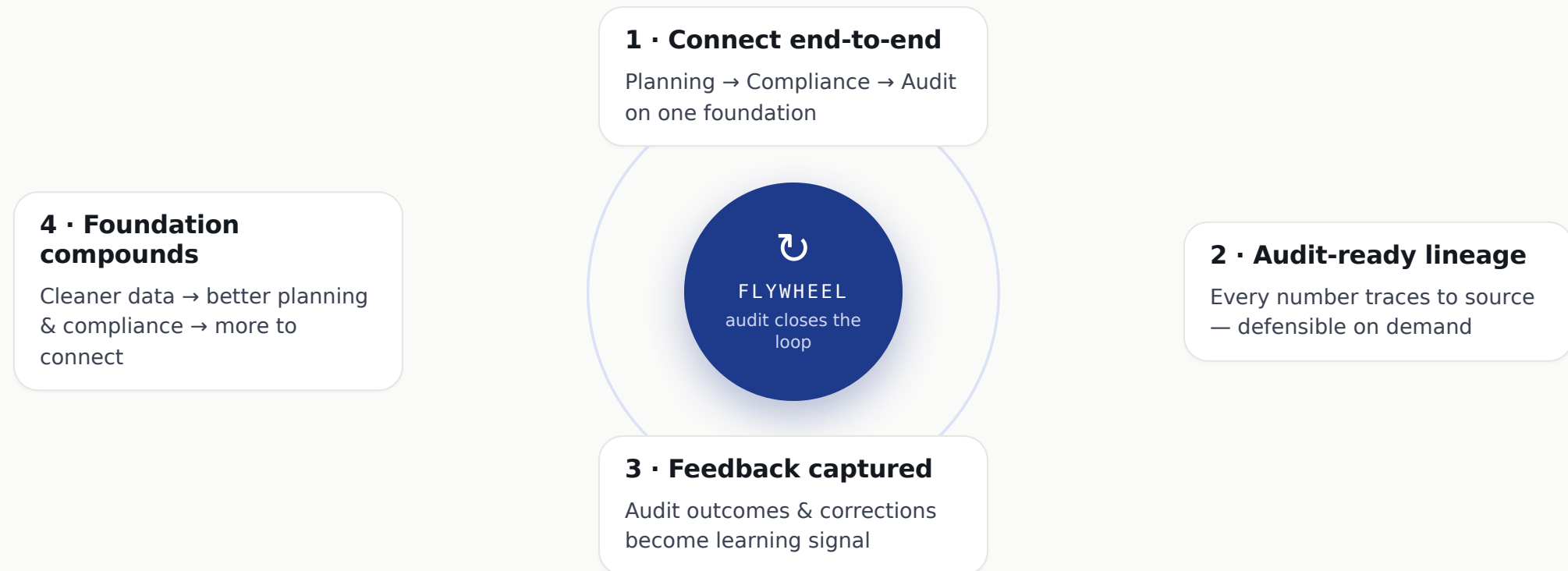
5

Reference historical audits

Real skills, in production — and each one makes the foundation stronger.

Connect end-to-end — a flywheel kicks in

Connect Planning → Compliance → Audit on one foundation and each loop compounds — **audit closes the loop.**



Each turn makes the data cleaner and the foundation smarter — **the exact feedback engine Stage 2 will run on.**

IN PLAIN TERMS

An AI agent is like a new team member

Think about what a person needs to do the job. An agent needs the same things — and **each one is a piece of infrastructure.**

THE AGENT NEEDS...

...WHICH IS INFRASTRUCTURE

 A brain — to reason & decide	→ Foundational AI model
 Skills — the tasks it can do	→ Skill library + management
 Hands — to act in your systems	→ Tool calling (MCP)
 Memory — to remember past work	→ Memory store
 Knowledge — your tax law & data	→ Data foundation
 Relationships — how entities, jurisdictions & products connect	→ Knowledge graph
 Context — the task in front of it	→ Grounding / retrieval
 Guardrails — judgment & sign-off	→ Trust & controls

The model is just the brain. **Everything else is the infrastructure** — and that's the work.

Why the model alone isn't enough

“Did we charge the right sales tax on this \$2M order shipped to Texas?”

The model alone

Knows Texas sales tax *in general*.
But not **your** order, your nexus,
today's rate — or how to prove it.

With the foundation, it can...

Data platform	pull the real order — \$2M, ship-to TX, the product SKU
Graph	which legal entity sold it · TX state→county→city · is the product taxable
Knowledge	today's Texas rule & rate — with a citation
Models	reason over all of it to an answer
Trust & controls	check who may see it · log every step
Eval + lineage	confidence check; unsure → human · every number traces back

The model is one slice of the answer. The **infrastructure is the rest** —
and the part that holds up in an audit.

Hard for most — but we have a head start

Why it's hard

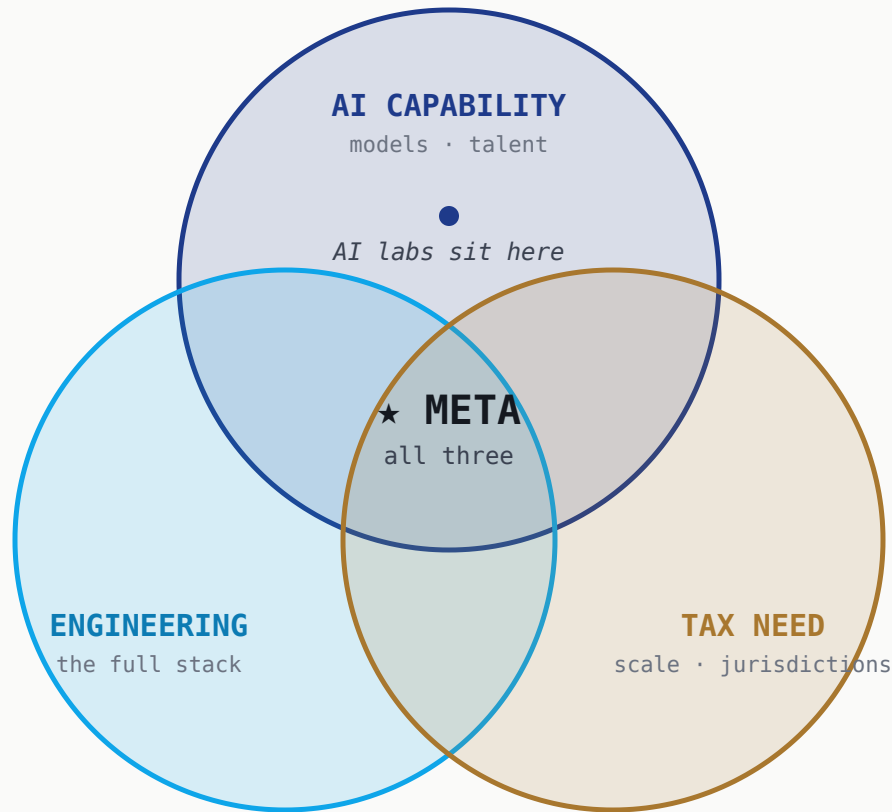
- Fragmented, messy data across ERPs & jurisdictions
- Real-time / streaming is a specialized skill set
- Talent fluent in tax *and* AI is doubly rare
- Split ownership: Tax vs. Finance Systems vs. IT
- Tax is a cost center — hard to fund infra

Why Meta is positioned

- Hyperscale data infrastructure already exists
- Real-time / event-driven by default
- World-class platform, data & ML engineers
- AI platform & compute in-house, not procured
- Engineering-owned tax tech — ships like a product team

The barriers most teams hit are largely **already solved here** — so we get to start where others can't.

The transformation takes all three at once



Why not the frontier labs?

- They're building the **ecosystem** — models, skills, MCP — and want you on their platform.
- But their **vertical** AI investment is coding-deep; for tax it's still surface-level.
- Lighter broad-engineering footprint, and an early tax footprint — one is just standing up a tax engine.

The horizontal AI is theirs to sell. The **vertical tax foundation is yours to own** — and it takes all three circles.

THE TAKEAWAY

Build the foundation now. Be ready when the harness arrives.

Coding shows the path. The three stages are real. The winning move in tax is Stage 1 — done well, across the lifecycle.

`taxbenchmark.ai`

Drop a qr.png here before
the talk.

Benchmark your tax-tech function

taxbenchmark.ai

Thank you · `contact@taxbenchmark.ai`